

Keep a copy of the terms and conditions

Keep a soft copy or a printed version of the company's terms and conditions (ToCs) at the time of placing the order, in case the company decides to alter them later on. You won't need this in most cases, but it's always better to know if the company has an absurd clause buried in its ToCs beforehand, rather than after you click the "Agree" button.

Read through user reviews

User reviews are a great source to determine not just the utility and quality of a product, but also the credibility of an e-commerce site. So be sure to go through these reviews, generally found at the bottom of a product listing, to ensure that along with the product, even your shopping experience on the site is worth every Rupee you're about to spend.

After receiving the order

Call them!

There are many companies that offer excellent return and replacement policies. In most cases a phone call to the selling company is all that is required to secure a replacement, return or refund.

A majority of the websites have clear and customer friendly guidelines for returns. If you're unable to find any such information from the website, you should not hesitate in calling up the company for clarifications.

If calling or sending emails doesn't help you arrive at a reasonable agreement with the seller, you could even register a consumer complaint with the credit card company so that the payment can be withheld until the matter is resolved. If even then your issue isn't resolved, you could seek legal help.

Written evidence

Get written confirmation of any agreements made over phone calls and keep a copy of the order statement. A copy of any correspondence with the seller over email should be stored safely, either in print if you're old fashioned or on your PC, in case you need it later as proof.

File a consumer complaint

A consumer complaint can be filed only where the company in question has its branch or where the the product was delivered/scheduled to be delivered. For this reason, if the e-commerce retailer is set up in another country, pursuing a legal action becomes excessively expensive. Moreover